

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Chemical release

CHEMICAL RADIATION / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Move away from a chemical release and follow official instructions about evacuation or sheltering indoors. If exposed, get the chemical off and seek help. For severe symptoms, call emergency services; in the U.S., Poison Control is 1-800-222-1222.

Do now.

**Leave the release area**

01

Do not approach a spill or plume to identify it.

**Follow shelter or evacuation orders**

02

The right action depends on the substance and where the release is; use location-specific instructions.

**Get clean**

03

Follow Poison Control or responder instructions for removing contaminated clothing and washing; avoid spreading contamination to others.

**Get medical help**

04

Tell responders what was involved if known, your location and symptoms.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If no reliable instruction arrives, move away from the visible release or affected area without passing through it. If leaving would put you into contaminated outdoor air, use an intact indoor space, shut openings and turn off outdoor-air intake while seeking trustworthy information. Do not identify a gas by sniffing it.

Watch for.

A dust mask or N95 does not protect against toxic gases.

People & practical needs.

Keep the family together in the correct shelter for the hazard and separate potentially contaminated items from the living area. Use covered food and safe water

Next decision.

Wait for official clearance before returning. Keep contaminated items isolated as responders direct.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Chemical release · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/chemical-emergency/>